ABEDELRAHMAN SHOLI

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Hands-on QA Lead | Open to Remote Roles | All Time Zones | Arabic: Native | English: Professional Working Proficiency

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA Lead with 11+ years across aviation, payments, healthcare and telecom. Leading dnata's move to AI-assisted test automation, from strategy and guardrails to team adoption. Leads QA engineers and vendor QA teams, owns release go/no-go, and stays hands-on, from framework design to debugging down to code and pipelines.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Release readiness and quality go/no-go, vendor QA governance, quality gates and SLAs, RFI/RFT/SOW review, hiring, mentoring, 1:1s and performance reviews, distributed teams.

Automation: Playwright (TypeScript), Selenium, Appium, RestAssured, SoapUI, Cucumber, JUnit, TestNG, hybrid web/API automation frameworks.

Testing: Exploratory, risk-based, API and integration, contract testing (OpenAPI/Swagger, PactFlow), real-device mobile testing (SauceLabs).

GenAI for QA: Claude, GitHub Copilot and Playwright agents for test-case generation, synthetic test data, automation authoring and AI-assisted test analysis.

Programming: Java (primary); TypeScript, JavaScript/Node.js; SQL.

CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Maven, Git, Docker.

Observability: Splunk.

Tools: Jira, QMetry, TestRail, Confluence, Agile/Scrum delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quality Assurance Lead - dnata International

Emirates Group, Dubai ***Jan 2026 - Present***

Promoted from Emirates to lead QA for four dnata programs: the Lounge Management System, an enterprise asset management platform, and in-flight retail for two European airline clients, live, in development or in test across the UK and Ireland, Europe, Africa, Australia, the Americas and the Middle East. Lead 2 QA engineers, govern 19 vendor QA engineers and report to a Director.

- Lead the strategy and rollout of AI-assisted test automation across the enterprise asset management platform and in-flight retail systems for European airline clients, moving teams from traditional automation to AI-assisted workflows with human review and approval at every step to prevent hallucinated outputs and data leakage.
- Owned release readiness and gave the quality go/no-go for each release, with product and business deciding whether to accept any remaining risk. Ran on-site UAT of the Lounge Management System (LMS) at lounges in Europe and Africa with business, product and vendor teams before a rollout with no critical issues.
- Governed QA delivery from five vendors across the programs: reviewed RFI, RFT and SOW responses, ran technical evaluations, sat on QA interview panels, and defined the SLAs and quality gates the vendors deliver against. On the in-flight retail programs I also built test automation.
- Worked directly with the Product Owner, Project and Delivery Managers and business teams on the dnata side, and with the vendors' development and test teams, from requirements through release.
- Reviewed a vendor's infrastructure design for testability and resilience, and raised a risk to performance test accuracy that led the vendor to change the design.
- Ran quality engineering workshops and internal talks across Emirates and dnata on ways of working and AI adoption in QA.
- Added contract and schema tests for program APIs with RestAssured against OpenAPI/Swagger specs, supported by PactFlow.
- Proposed and added failure categories to the Allure reports, so failures in each run are triaged faster.

- Built a Playwright (TypeScript) framework for web and API integration testing of the enterprise asset management platform, live in Switzerland and Italy with more airports and stations to follow: about 600 end-to-end scenarios written with Playwright agents and AI-assisted authoring, running in GitLab CI after moving it from Jenkins to GitLab CI with SauceLabs.
- Helped another dnata team with automation on its food safety (HACCP) catering app: redesigned the Selenium and Appium framework on a new architecture, cutting the regression run from 8h to about 3h, with mobile suites on real Samsung devices in GitLab and Jenkins pipelines.
- Built and ran the concierge app locally in Docker to test it when it was not available in the SIT environment.
- On my own initiative, built an IATA 792 barcode generator and decoder that creates synthetic boarding data, so lower environments hold no passenger PII and automation has repeatable test data.
- Used Splunk logs to reproduce bugs and build PII-free test data, and traced test and pipeline failures to root cause across the application, APIs and GitLab CI before raising them with developers.
- Used Claude, GitHub Copilot, Playwright agents and Emirates Group's internal AI tool (Aura) for test cases, synthetic test data and first drafts of automation scripts, cutting manual documentation work.
- Took part in the pilot of Aura, Emirates Group's Claude-based AI tool: reviewed its outputs manually and tested its guardrails with manipulated prompts.

Lead Quality Assurance Engineer

Emirates Group, Dubai ***Jan 2024 - Jan 2026***

Led QA for core Emirates passenger-service and payment platforms across web, mobile and API, with a team of 3 engineers who reported to me, whom I mentored.

- Led end-to-end QA for Emirates Resconnect (Reservations, Ticketing, Check-In): test plans, functional, integration and regression testing across web, mobile and middleware.
- Led the QA work in sprints with the Product Owner, Scrum Master, designers and in-house developers: refined acceptance criteria with the Product Owner and joined sprint planning with the Scrum Master and Project Manager.
- Planned test coverage for the payment gateway migration by risk, so critical payment cases were covered first and the remaining effort went to the scenarios that mattered most to customers.
- Ran UAT with business teams, with training sessions and walkthroughs so operations were ready for each release.
- On my own initiative, used production data during the migration to check which cards customers really use, found one that would have failed on the new version, and proposed a routing fix that kept the release on its planned date.
- Found a payment failure when switching payment method mid-entry through exploratory testing, affecting web, mobile and call center users. Caught before release.
- Raised UX risks, missing test cards and untested flows early in the same release, and worked with designers on payment gateway UI changes that made the flow easier for end users.
- Built UI automation (Selenium, Cucumber) and API and contract tests (RestAssured, Cucumber, OpenAPI/Swagger) for the XML-to-JSON migration across global and local card types, on a gateway processing millions of transactions worldwide.
- Extended the existing Selenium framework, ran web and mobile suites on SauceLabs through Jenkins, wrote JUnit unit tests inside the framework, and debugged application, API and CI pipeline failures to root cause before raising them with developers.

Senior QA Engineer

IQVIA, Palestine - Remote ***Sep 2021 - Jan 2024***

Led QA for IQVIA's healthcare SaaS suite serving providers, payers and patients across the Middle East and parts of Europe: 8 interconnected products, with a team of 5 QA automation engineers in Jordan, India, the UAE and Oman. Hired for the team and ran 1:1s, performance reviews and mentoring.

- Worked with in-house developers and Product across the 8-product program, from design discussions through release.
- Defined release readiness criteria, shift-left QA strategy and test plans across the 8-product program, and ran test execution and defect triage across distributed teams.

- Coordinated UAT, demos and release sign-off with Product and operations teams, tracking QA KPIs and defect trends.
- Reached 90% requirements coverage across the suite, tracked through a requirements traceability matrix in Jira, supporting the multi-country rollout across the Middle East and Europe.
- Designed a modular automation architecture for microservices platforms, cutting execution time from 8h to 4h.
- Debugged automation and application failures to root cause and ran root-cause analysis with developers.
- Wrote automation with Selenium WebDriver, RestAssured and TestNG, with YAML-based configuration.
- Ran JMeter tests on healthcare backend APIs and joined the performance testers in reviewing the results and other performance metrics.
- Joined architecture discussions on serverless solutions to align the test strategy with the design.
- Built quality dashboards and automated shift-left test gates tracking defect density, coverage, pass rate and release readiness.

QA Engineer

ProGineer Technologies, Palestine - Remote ***Nov 2019 - Sep 2021***

ProGineer Technologies is a Palestine-based company serving as a delivery partner to PDF Solutions, Inc. (Santa Clara, CA).

- Implemented and maintained the Quality Assurance plan across product releases.
- Performed manual testing for desktop applications and APIs, and reported and tracked defects in Jira.
- Built Java tools for the QA team, including an automated deployment tool and a utility that updates thousands of XML files to match changing requirements.
- Executed backend database validation for enterprise web platforms.
- Standardized QA documentation, templates and workflows, and mentored engineers.

Systems Integration Engineer

Ooredoo (Wataniya Mobile Palestine), Palestine ***May 2015 - Nov 2019***

Developed, monitored and operated integration systems within an SOA environment.

- Analyzed, designed, tested, debugged and documented integration flows and services in SOA Suite.
- Ran end-to-end, regression, functional and API testing across telecom platforms.
- Set up a daily cron job that scanned production database logs, flagged issues and emailed a report to the team.
- Upgraded and automated reconciliation routines, reducing manual effort by 40% and removing recurring data errors.
- Automated daily reporting of transaction failures, API performance and errors.
- Investigated incidents and ran root-cause analysis with cross-functional teams.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) - EC-Council

Arab German Academy, one-year hands-on course followed by the certification exam *2015 - 2016*

BSc Telecommunication Engineering

An-Najah National University *2010 - 2015*